Casey R. Caster Jr.

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Okta
Re: Senior Director, R&D Planning & Operations (P7363)

Dear Okta Hiring Team,

What excites me most is helping a business do what it didn't think it could. That's what draws me to the Senior Director, R&D Planning & Operations role at Okta, and in particular the chance to define how a 2,000+ person R&D organization budgets for, measures and optimizes its AI spend.

At Ripple, I started with four project managers who couldn't keep up with customer demand. That team grew into a global organization, and the result I point to is that banks could go live on RippleNet in eight weeks instead of eight months.

Today I lead Engineering Infrastructure & Internal Services at SingleStore with the same mindset. I give people clear direction, build what the business needs, and change course when a better opportunity shows up. We cut internal cloud spend in half. I manage the engineering budget with Finance, built a COGS intelligence engine with them, and negotiate with our vendors, including on LLM token pricing. I run the capacity planning and delivery dashboards our engineering leaders work from, and I integrated acquired teams after leading their technical due diligence.

Three gaps to name up front: I haven't run Capitalized Software accounting or R&D tax credit programs, and I've managed the engineering budget with Finance rather than owning a P&L. All three draw on the engineering capacity and cost data I already work with, so I'd close them quickly with your Finance and Tax partners.

I work in San Francisco today and I'm glad to be in the office several days a week. I'd like to hear where you want to take Okta R&D and talk about how I can help you get there faster.

Best,

Casey Caster